

COURSE INFORMATION

Course Code & Title COR-COMM1313 - Intercultural Communication	Effective Start Date 17/08/2026
Offering Unit / Department / School LKCSB	Course Career Undergraduate
Course Units CU: 1	Grading Basis GRD - Graded

Course Description

The course provides strategies on how to read a person’s culture as well as corporate culture. Features of culture such as individualism and collectivism, masculinity and femininity, power distance and issues related to intercultural adaptation, ethnocentrism, stereotyping and prejudice will be discussed. The knowledge and discussion gleaned from this course will provide strategies on how to be culturally competent, so that leadership and relationships will have the marks of diligence and empathy of global citizens. The aim of this course is to develop intercultural competencies, which will make business practices more meaningful and significant. The course will also provide strategies on how to deliver inclusion and diversity imperatives in the workplace, by speech and deed. Those who work and relate to demographics different from their own will also find this course particularly helpful, including those of other ethnicities, nationalities and cultural dispositions.

Course Learning Outcomes

By the end of this course, students will be able to:

- Read a person's culture as well as corporate culture using the axioms of intercultural communication
- Manage speech and behaviour at meetings and work contexts that demonstrate to colleagues and clients fairness and impartiality despite different cultural orientations
- Demonstrate intercultural communication competencies, including being sensitive towards colleagues and clients of different ethnicities, nationalities, age, gender, religion and different cultural dispositions
- Manage intercultural conflict with sound axioms that promote inclusion and diversity
- Develop knowledge and skills in managing multi-cultural communication
- Manage and implement practices and values that uphold equality and divergent points of view
- Imbibe and practice management styles that are culturally sensitive to different norms of nonverbal communication including time, space and form
- Manage differences by forging sound values and unity, from orientation and on-boarding of new staff to daily strategic communication with employees and clients

SMU Graduate Learning Outcomes

Interdisciplinary knowledge, Innovation and enterprising skills, Communication, Intercultural understanding and sensitivity

Competencies

Marketing Communications Plan Development, Media Strategy Development, Content Strategy, Organisational Relationship Building, Crisis Communication and Media Management

Course Area(s)

AREA - Arts & Culture Mgmt Electives, AREA - Business Options, AREA - Business-Oriented Electives, AREA - Capabilities - Managing, AREA - Communication Management Electives, AREA - Econ Major Rel/Econ Options, AREA - General Education - Arts, AREA - Social Sciences/PLE Major-related, ENRL - SS Enrolment: 4 ISEP; 1 SUSEP, RQCX - COMM122, RQCX - COMM254, TRCK - COMM: Data, Design and Communication Track, TRCK - Culture, Org & Behaviour Track (Business)

Simple Requisites

COR-COMM1313/COMM122/COMM254 - Mutually Exclusive

Type

Antirequisite

Enroll in the following Courses:

• COMM122 - Intercultural Communication – An Asian Perspective (Inactive)

• COMM254 - Overseas Project Experience (Corporate Culture and Values in Asia)

CLASS SECTION INFORMATION

Instructor(s)
ONG SIOW HENG ONG (shong@smu.edu.sg)

Instruction Mode

In Person

Office Location

LKCSB #4072

Assessment Components (New)

Category* Projects/Assignments		Weightage* 40		Assessment/Submission Period* Week 13			
Description Group Project		Individual or Group?* Group		With Writing Component?* Yes		With Oral Component?* Yes	

Category* Class Participation		Weightage* 20					
Description Participation and Professionalism		Individual or Group?* Individual		With Writing Component?* No		With Oral Component?* Yes	

Category* Progress Assessments		Weightage* 40		Assessment/Submission Period* Week 10			
Description Term Test		Individual or Group?* Individual		With Writing Component?* Yes		With Oral Component?* No	

Category* Projects/Assignments				Assessment/Submission Period* Week 10			
Description Written Journal Reports		Individual or Group?* Individual		With Writing Component?* Yes		With Oral Component?* No	

Instructional Methods and Expectations

The pedagogical style that is employed in SMU seminars is one of many reasons why the university has gained much positive attention. The cooperation of the instructor and students is critical in the successful delivery of meaningful and productive seminars. Participation in seminars is therefore vital. To derive maximum benefit from the seminars, you are reminded to be present and on time for all sessions of COMM120.

The following policy for absences in relation to the final grade is a statement of the cooperative enterprise that both instructors and students will commit to:

3 or more unexcused absences (F grade)

2 unexcused absences (C+ grade or lower)

Providing documentation for any absence does help lower the impact of your absence on your participation grade. If you cannot be in class for any reason, let the instructor and TA know in advance by email. The attendance policy for this course will be fully delineated during the first lesson.

Weekly Lesson Plan

WEEK NO.	TOPIC
1	Introduction/Overview Why Study Intercultural Communication? Complexities of Communication, Culture, the Workplace and Business
2	Verbal Communication and Intercultural Communication; Managing our Speech in Meetings, Client Outreach and Interaction; Oral Journal Reports
3	Nonverbal Communication and Intercultural Communication; Managing our Nonverbal Communication within the organization and in External Communication; Chronemics, Gustics, Proxemics, Objectics, Haptics, Oculesics, Olfactics; Oral Journal Reports
4	Individualism and Collectivism; Masculinity and Femininity; Sharpening Interpersonal Skills and Building Relationships in the midst of different working styles; Oral Journal Reports
5	”Get Out”/”Joy Luck Club”; Lessons on Inclusivity, Diversity and Growth
6	Power Distance; Forging Equality and Impartiality in the Workplace; Managing Hierarchical Differences; Corporate Social Responsibility; Oral Journal Reports
7	Ethnocentrism, Stereotyping, Prejudice and Racism; Equality and Developing a Global Mindset in Interactions Internally and Externally; Oral Journal Reports
8	Mid-Term Break
9	Culture Shock/Intercultural Adaptation; A Universal Culture?; Coexistence of Local and Global Perspectives and Dispositions; Relationships and Episodes in Intercultural Communication; Professionalism and Relationship Building; Skills of the Global Citizen and Cultural Competencies; Oral Journal Reports
10	Term Test (the combined online term test for all sections of this course will be on Saturday, 24 October 2026, 2-5pm)
11-13	Project Presentations, Feedback and Review of Learning Objectives

Recommended Textbooks and Readings

Lilian H. Chaney and Jeanette S. Martin Intercultural Business Communication (recent edition) Pearson Prentice Hall All other readings And handouts will be uploaded on eLearn one month before the course commences

UNIVERSITY POLICIES

Academic Integrity

All acts of academic dishonesty (including, but not limited to, plagiarism, cheating, fabrication, facilitation of acts of academic dishonesty by others, unauthorized possession of exam questions, or tampering with the academic work of other students) are serious offences.

All work (whether oral or written) submitted for purposes of assessment must be the student's own work. Penalties for violation of the policy range from zero marks for the component assessment to expulsion, depending on the nature of the offence.

When in doubt, students should consult the instructors of the course. Details on the SMU Code of Academic Integrity may be accessed at <https://smu.sharepoint.com/sites/oasis/SitePages/DOS-WKLSWC/UCSC.aspx>.

Responsible Use of AI

The University recognises the importance of equipping students with the skills to navigate an AI-driven world. While AI tools may support learning, they must be used judiciously and responsibly. Students must not present AI-generated output as their own work.

Each course may set specific guidelines on the use of AI in assessments. Students are required to follow these guidelines carefully and should seek clarification from the instructors if uncertain.

Misuse of AI constitutes a breach of academic integrity and will be subject to the same penalties as other acts of academic dishonesty.

Copyright Notice

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Accessibility

SMU strives to make learning experiences accessible for all. Students who anticipate or experience physical or academic barriers due to disability are encouraged to inform the course instructor as soon as possible. Students may also contact the university's disability services team if they have questions or concerns about academic provisions: accessibility@smu.edu.sg. Please be aware that the accessible tables in our seminar room should remain available for students who require them.

Digital Readiness for Teaching and Learning (DRTL)

As part of emergency preparedness, instructors may conduct lessons online via the Zoom platform during the term, to prepare students for online learning. During an actual emergency, students will be notified to access the Zoom platform for their online lessons. The class schedule will mirror the current face-to-face class timetable unless otherwise stated.